EXECUTIVE LEADERSHIP PORTFOLIO • 2026

Design Leadership at Scale

Architecting Enterprise UX, Production Design Systems, and High-Velocity Engineering Collaboration across Global Fortune 500 Technology Organizations.



PRESENTER

Balaajee V.R.

UI/UX Design Senior Manager

Ex-IBM • Zebra • ZF Wabco
Ericsson • Infosys

18+	10M+	12+	40%
YEARS EXPERIENCE	USERS IMPACTED	TEAM SCALE LED	VELOCITY GAIN

Enterprise Pedigree

Senior design leadership spanning **IBM Software Labs, Zebra Technologies, ZF Wabco, Ericsson, Samsung, and Infosys** across multi-tier B2B, B2C, and B2E architectures.

IBM · Zebra · ZF Wabco · Ericsson · Infosys · Samsung

- 18+ Years Global Tech Experience
- Enterprise AI, B2B SaaS & Industrial IoT

Systems & Token Architecture

Pioneered cross-brand enterprise design systems with automated token pipelines bridging Figma to React, Angular, and native Android Kotlin repositories with zero visual drift.

Figma Tokens · Style-Dictionary · React & Angular · Android Compose

- Automated Zero-Drift CI/CD Pipelines
- Multi-Brand Theming & WCAG AA Compliance

People & Culture Catalyst

Mentored 50+ designers and engineers. Established career leveling frameworks, design sprint rituals, and psychological safety that drive retention and high innovation velocity.

50+ Mentored · Team Scale (3 to 12+) · DesignOps · 10-Yr US Visa

- Structured Career Ladders (Assoc. to Principal)
- Global Hack-Fest & Spot Innovation Awards

CORE LEADERSHIP FRAMEWORK

Four Pillars of Executive Design

Bridging executive business objectives, technical engineering constraints, and human-centered design to build compounding enterprise value.

PILLAR 01 • BUSINESS STRATEGY

1. Commercial ROI & Executive Alignment

Design is an investment, not an expense. Every initiative directly targets commercial KPIs: accelerating enterprise ARR, lowering customer churn, eliminating support tickets, and shortening enterprise B2B sales cycles.

ARR Expansion | Executive Buy-In | Churn Reduction

→ Dictates Systems Architecture

PILLAR 02 • SCALE & GOVERNANCE

2. Systems-First Scalability

Eliminating redundant component rebuilds through automated token pipelines. Enforcing multi-brand UI governance, WCAG 2.1 AA accessibility compliance, and code-aligned component libraries.

Design Tokens | WCAG 2.1 AA | Single Source of Truth

→ Unlocks Engineering Velocity

PILLAR 04 • PEOPLE & CULTURE

4. High-Empathy Talent Cultivation

Empowering designers through psychological safety, constructive critiques, and explicit career progression pathways (from Associate to Principal). Fostering an inclusive, high-retention environment.

Career Frameworks | Psychological Safety | DesignOps Mentorship

→ Compounds Business Strategy

PILLAR 03 • ENGINEERING SYNERGY

3. Engineering Synergy & Code Parity

With an engineering background (B.E. Information Technology), I speak the language of software architects. I eliminate the "designer-developer divide" through shared design-to-code pipelines and proactive technical feasibility reviews.

Zero-Drift Handoff | Component Parity | Feasibility Reviews

→ Empowers Autonomous Talent

OPERATING MODEL & ORGANIZATIONAL ARCHITECTURE

How I Structure & Scale Design Teams

The Hybrid Pod Model: Combining centralized design system governance with decentralized, embedded product squad execution.

CENTRAL CORE HUB

DesignOps & Systems Governance

Dedicated organizational core establishing scalable design standards, accessibility compliance, and design-to-code pipelines across all enterprise software suites.

- Figma Token Studio & Semantic Variables
- Automated Style-Dictionary CI/CD Engine
- WCAG 2.1 AAA Accessibility & Usability Lab
- Storybook Parity & Zero Visual Drift

↔

Squad A: Enterprise AI & Systems Modeling
Embedded with Watson AI architects & aerospace systems engineering leads at IBM.
`4 Designers • 18 Eng`

Squad B: Industrial B2B & Rugged Ecosystem
Embedded with Android Kotlin & hardware firmware engineering teams at Zebra.
`5 Designers • 22 Eng`

Squad C: Commercial Telematics & Safety IoT
Embedded with cloud telemetry & vehicle HMI engineers at ZF Wabco.
`3 Designers • 14 Eng`

STAGE 01 • DISCOVER
Generative user research, stakeholder alignment, persona definitions, and KPI mapping.

STAGE 02 • DEFINE
Information architecture, journey mapping, low-fi wireframing, and technical feasibility.

STAGE 03 • DESIGN & TEST
Token-based high-fidelity UI, interactive prototypes, usability validation, and critiques.

STAGE 04 • DELIVER & SCALE
Automated token handoff, QA visual review, production rollout, and analytics feedback.

FLAGSHIP ENTERPRISE CASE STUDY 01

IBM Software Labs: Enterprise AI-UX Transformation

Re-architecting complex enterprise modeling (Rhapsody SE) and enterprise mobility management (MaaS360) by integrating IBM Watson AI workflows.

IBM INDIA SOFTWARE LABS | UI/UX Design Senior Manager | Sep 2024 – Jan 2026 • Enterprise Systems Portfolio

OPERATIONAL FRICTION

Cognitive Fatigue & Policy Fragmentation

- **Legacy Modeling Overload:** Aerospace & automotive systems engineers faced severe cognitive fatigue navigating dense legacy UML/SysML modeling suites in Rhapsody SE.
- **Fragmented Endpoint Triage:** IT administrators faced constant alert fatigue manually auditing policy compliance across hundreds of thousands of corporate devices in MaaS360.

High Support Escalations | Cognitive Overload

STRATEGIC SYSTEMS INTERVENTION

UX-as-a-Service Pods & Contextual Watson AI

- **UXaaS Pod Organization:** Re-architected 12 designers from isolated product silos into a unified UX-as-a-Service model, establishing shared design sprint cadences and component governance.
- **Watson AI Interaction Patterns:** Designed conversational copilots and contextual AI recommendations that proactively suggest policy fixes and automate model validations.

UX-as-a-Service | IBM Watson AI | Predictive Workflows

35%
MODEL VERIFICATION VELOCITY
Reduction in model verification cycle time for global aerospace & automotive engineering clients.

45%
ADMIN TRIAGE REDUCTION
Cut IT administrator triage time by replacing reactive alert dashboards with proactive AI policy mitigations.

12+
GLOBAL DESIGNERS UNIFIED
Standardized cross-product design execution and component reuse across squads in the US, Europe, and India.

FLAGSHIP ENTERPRISE CASE STUDY 02

Zebra Technologies: Industrial B2B Ecosystem at Scale

Unifying hardware-software UX ecosystems across rugged mobile computers, RFID scanners, and enterprise supply chain platforms.

ZEBRA TECHNOLOGIES | UI/UX Product Design Manager | Jul 2021 – Aug 2024 • Global B2B Hardware & Software

OPERATIONAL FRICTION

Extreme Ambient & Harsh Physical Constraints

- **Hostile Environmental Factors:** Warehouse operators and drivers operate in direct sunlight glare, dark cold storage (-20°C), loud ambient noise, and heavy gloved one-hand touch.
- **Fragmented Device UX:** Disconnected design execution across legacy rugged Android devices and web portals caused high cognitive fatigue and scanning error rates.

Gloved Touch Bottlenecks | High Scan Errors

STRATEGIC SYSTEMS INTERVENTION

Glanceable Patterns & Multi-Platform Governance

- **Industrial-Grade Design System:** Standardized high-contrast glanceable color tokens, touch targets calibrated for heavy gloves, and multi-modal audio/haptic feedback.
- **Shared Token Architecture:** Deployed unified design tokens directly bridging Figma variants to Android Kotlin/Jetpack Compose and cloud web repositories.

Android Compose | Glanceable HMI | Haptic/Audio Feedback

40%
HANDOFF ACCELERATION
Accelerated sprint velocity and engineering handoff through shared Android Kotlin/Compose design tokens.

22%
OPERATOR THROUGHPUT
Increased scanning throughput and slashed input error rates across Tier-1 retail & logistics enterprise hubs.

100%
ENTERPRISE GOVERNANCE
Architected design system governance adopted across Zebra's hardware product lines and enterprise cloud software.

FLAGSHIP ENTERPRISE CASE STUDY 03

ZF Wabco: Mission-Critical Fleet Telematics

Designing safety-critical, zero-distraction driver interfaces and real-time cloud telemetry platforms for commercial fleet operators.

ZF WABCO UI/UX Senior Specialist — Oct 2020 – Jul 2021 • Commercial Vehicle Telematics

OPERATIONAL FRICTION

Driver Distraction Risks & Highway Breakdown Latency

- **Safety-Critical HMI Cognitive Load:** In-cabin commercial truck interfaces risked severe driver distraction during high-speed freight transit if alerts were not strictly glanceable and ISO-compliant.
- **Unplanned Fleet Downtime:** Fleet dispatchers lacked predictive insights into vehicle health, resulting in sudden roadside breakdowns costing millions in delays and towing.

Driver Distraction Hazard | Unplanned Fleet Downtime

STRATEGIC SYSTEMS INTERVENTION

ISO 15005 Glanceable HMI & Predictive Telematics Portal

- **Zero-Distraction HMI Architecture:** Engineered in-cabin driver displays strictly compliant with NHTSA & ISO 15005 driver distraction standards, prioritizing critical brake & ESC alerts.
- **High-Density Telemetry Portal:** Built real-time dispatch telemetry maps and predictive dashboards enabling fleet operators to monitor thousands of vehicles with zero latency.

ISO 15005 Compliant | Real-Time IoT Maps | Predictive Maintenance

18%
BRAKING REACTION VELOCITY
Reduced driver reaction latency to critical safety and brake warnings through glanceable HMI interaction design.

48 hrs
PREDICTIVE FAULT WINDOW
Enabled fleet managers to schedule predictive maintenance 48 hours earlier, preventing catastrophic highway failures.

Zero
HMI TO CLOUD DRIFT
Single unified design token pipeline established across in-vehicle Android automotive units and cloud dispatch web consoles.

DESIGN SYSTEMS & TOKEN ARCHITECTURE

Enterprise Token Architecture

How I architect robust, multi-brand design systems that eliminate redundant coding and guarantee 100% fidelity from Figma to Production.

PHASE 01

Figma Token Studio

Design Token Authoring

- Semantic color & typography scales
- Calibrated 8pt spacing & elevation
- Multi-brand alias theme tokens

→ Git Webhook Push

PHASE 02

Style-Dictionary CI/CD

Automated Compilation

- GitHub Actions automated trigger
- JSON parsing & contract checks
- Zero manual copy-pasting of hex

→ Multi-Platform Build

PHASE 03

Multi-Platform Repos

Native Code Artifacts

- Web: CSS Variables & SCSS Maps
- Frontend: React & Angular TS packages
- Mobile: Android Kotlin / Compose

→ Continuous Verification

PHASE 04

Storybook & WCAG AA

Zero Visual Drift

- Automated axe-core a11y scanner
- 1:1 component props mirror Figma
- Zeroheight live documentation sync

✓ Production Ready

40%	100%	0	Multi
HANDOFF ACCELERATION	WCAG 2.1 AA COMPLIANCE	REDUNDANT COMPONENT CODE	BRAND THEMING ENABLED

INNOVATION & FUTURE-PROOFING

AI-Augmented DesignOps & Agentic UX

Integrating modern generative AI into user research, prototyping, and product design operations while designing intuitive AI interaction models.

ENGINE 01 • INTERNAL ACCELERATION

AI for DesignOps (Team Multiplier)

Scaling sprint throughput & eliminating repetitive operational friction

01 LLM User Research Synthesis
Synthesizing thousands of customer support transcripts and usability session recordings into prioritized thematic clusters and executive opportunity maps.

02 Automated Heuristic & A11y Gates
Running automated axe-core accessibility contrast scanners and Figma token conformance audits directly within GitHub Actions pull requests.

03 Agentic Prototype Scaffolding
Utilizing agentic code generation to convert Figma component token specs into interactive React / Storybook test harnesses in minutes.

EVALUATION & FEEDBACK LOOP

ENGINE 02 • ENTERPRISE UX

UX for AI Systems (Human Agency)

Designing human-in-the-loop interfaces for non-deterministic AI workflows

01 Explainability & Confidence Scoring
Designing user-facing confidence ratings, transparent inline citations, and progressive reasoning disclosure to build operator trust in enterprise AI.

02 Graceful Degradation & Streaming UI
Ensuring non-blocking progressive skeleton loaders and instant fallbacks when inference models experience elevated network or processing latency.

03 Authoritative Human-in-the-Loop Controls
Providing explicit one-click undo affordances, manual parameter override sliders, and audit logging so enterprise operators maintain absolute decision authority.

ENTERPRISE TOOLING & AI STACK (MATCHING RESUME PROFILE):

Microsoft Copilot | ChatGPT Enterprise | IBM Watson | Google Stitch & NotebookLM | Figma & Token Studio | Storybook & React | UserTesting & Hotjar | Jira & Confluence

LEADERSHIP, CULTURE & MENTORSHIP

Cultivating High-Performance Design Teams

How I hire, mentor, and elevate multi-disciplinary design organizations through structured career progression and psychological safety.

ORGANIZATIONAL FRAMEWORK

Transparent Progression

Structured 4-Tier Career Progression Ladder

Explicit evaluation across Craft, Strategy, Systems Thinking & Organizational Leadership

Tier 04 • Principal / Staff Designer — Staff / Principal
Enterprise Portfolio Strategy, Systems-to-Code Governance & Executive Board Alignment.

Tier 03 • Lead / Senior Product Designer — Senior / Lead
Autonomous Squad Leadership, Complex Problem Framing & Cross-Functional Mentorship.

Tier 02 • Mid-Level Product Designer — Mid-Level
End-to-End Feature UX, Usability Validation & Tokenized Design System Contributions.

Tier 01 • Associate Designer — Associate
UI/UX Craft Fundamentals, Component Token Adherence & Active Critique Participation.

CULTURE & PSYCHOLOGICAL SAFETY

Cultivating safe-to-fail experimentation, weekly cross-product design jams, constructive critiques, and proactive 1-on-1 coaching that eliminates burnout and drives team retention.

Weekly Design Jams | Psychological Safety

GLOBAL INNOVATION HONORS

- **Samsung:** 10-Year US Business Visa for global healthcare UX research.
- **Ericsson:** Spot Award for UX innovation & 1st Place in Global Hack-fest.
- **Industry:** 1st Place in MockingBOT & UP Labs global design challenges.

50+	3 ➔ 12+	0%	18+ Yrs
DESIGNERS & ENG MENTORED	SQUAD SCALING CAPACITY	REGRETTED ATTRITION	ENTERPRISE LEADERSHIP TRACK

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY & ENGAGEMENT

Executive Scorecard & Next Steps

Ready to drive enterprise UX transformation, scalable design systems, and world-class product design leadership for your organization.

18+	10M+	40%	100%
YEARS EXPERIENCE	USERS IMPACTED	DEV VELOCITY GAIN	DESIGN-TO-CODE PARITY

Target Leadership Roles

- **Director of Product Design / Head of UX**
- **Senior Manager — UI/UX & Design Systems**
- **Principal UX Architect / DesignOps Leader**
- **Vice President of Design (Enterprise / B2B)**

Direct Contact & Portfolio Channels

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